

VAN LIFER

The Van Lifer Overland Gear Checklist

Vans offer the most livable space for long-haul overlanding. Your priorities are a robust power system (solar + lithium), a quality fridge, a rooftop vent fan, and a reliable GPS/comms setup for remote areas. Priority: 1 = do first, 2 = next season, 3 = nice-to-have.

POWER SYSTEM (MOST CRITICAL FOR VANS)

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| ■ EcoFlow Delta Pro Power Station (3.6 kWh) | Priority 1 |
| Best-in-class for van builds. Expandable, fast charge, AC output. | |
| trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-portable-power-stations-for-overlanding.html | |
| ■ Renogy 400W Solar Kit (roof mount) | Priority 1 |
| 2× 200W panels on roof rack. Keeps Delta Pro topped off in most conditions. | |
| trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-solar-and-power.html | |
| ■ Victron SmartSolar MPPT 100/50 Controller | Priority 1 |
| Best MPPT controller. Bluetooth monitoring via Victron Connect app. | |
| trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-solar-and-power.html | |
| ■ Shore Power Adapter (30A RV plug) | Priority 2 |
| Charge from campground hookups when available. | |
| ■ 12V Distribution Panel (Blue Sea) | Priority 1 |
| Fused panel for fridge, lights, fan, and accessories. | |
| ■ Victron Battery Monitor (BMV-712) | Priority 2 |
| Know your state of charge. Prevents over-discharge. | |

REFRIGERATION & FOOD

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| ■ Dometic CFX3 45 or 55 Fridge / Freezer | Priority 1 |
| Best fridge for vans. Efficient, quiet, and holds temp in hot weather.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-fridges.html | |
| ■ 2-Burner Propane Stove (Camp Chef Everest) | Priority 1 |
| For cooking outside. Pair with a windscreen for efficiency. | |
| ■ Instant Pot or Pressure Cooker | Priority 3 |
| Efficient cooking at altitude. One pot, many meals. | |
| ■ Collapsible Cookware Set | Priority 1 |
| Saves space. GSI Outdoors makes excellent compact sets. | |

WATER SYSTEM

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| ■ Fresh Water Tank (20–30 gal, built-in) | Priority 1 |
| Best option for full-time van life. Pair with a 12V pump.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-water-storage-and-filtration.html | |
| ■ Berkey Water Filter (countertop) | Priority 1 |
| Gravity-fed, no power required. Filters 3,000+ gallons per element.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-water-storage-and-filtration.html | |
| ■ Sawyer Squeeze (backup) | Priority 1 |
| Lightweight backup for hiking and emergencies. | |
| ■ Grey Water Container (5 gal) | Priority 1 |
| Required at many campgrounds. Don't dump grey water on the ground. | |

VENTILATION & COMFORT

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| ■ Maxxair Fan 7500K (roof vent) | Priority 1 |
| Best van roof fan. 10-speed, rain sensor, works in rain. | |
| ■ Reflectix Window Insulation | Priority 1 |
| Cut to window size. Blocks heat and light. Essential for summer. | |
| ■ Thinsulate Insulation (3M SM600L) | Priority 1 |
| Best van insulation. Doesn't absorb moisture. Install before buildout. | |
| ■ Diesel Heater (Webasto, Espar, or Chinese clone) | Priority 1 |
| Propane is dangerous in enclosed spaces. Diesel heater is the safe choice. | |

RECOVERY & SAFETY

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| ■ | MaxTrax MKII Recovery Boards
Vans get stuck too. Essential for soft surfaces.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-recovery-gear.html | Priority 1 |
| ■ | Overlanding First Aid Kit
Remote-rated kit. Carry tourniquet and wound packing.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-first-aid-kit-essentials.html | Priority 1 |
| ■ | CO + Propane Detector
Non-negotiable for any van with a combustion appliance. | Priority 1 |
| ■ | Fire Extinguisher (2.5 lb ABC)
Mount near the door for quick access. | Priority 1 |
| ■ | Tire Repair Kit + Portable Compressor
Vans run high-load tires. Carry plugs and a compressor. | Priority 1 |

NAVIGATION & COMMUNICATION

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| ■ | Garmin inReach Mini 2
Satellite communicator. Essential for remote van travel.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-vehicle-communication-gear-for-overlanding.html | Priority 1 |
| ■ | Onx Offroad App
Shows dispersed camping areas and land ownership. | Priority 1 |
| ■ | Cell Signal Booster (WeBoost Drive Reach)
Extends cell signal in remote areas. Useful for work-from-van setups. | Priority 2 |
| ■ | GMRS Radio
Convoy communication and emergency use.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-vehicle-communication-gear-for-overlanding.html | Priority 2 |